

BENJAMIN D. THORNBURG, PHD

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RESEARCH STATEMENT

I use quasi-experimental methods, claims data, surveys, and other administrative information to study market structure, provider labor, and policy in behavioral and maternal healthcare.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Fellow in Health Economics Oregon Health and Science University Advisor: Jane Zhu, MD, MPP, MSPH	2025-Present
Fellow, Center for Health Systems Effectiveness Oregon Health and Science University	2026-Present

EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University PhD in Health Economics and Policy Dissertation Title: <i>Mental Health and Healthcare After the Dobbs Abortion Decision</i> Committee Chair: Elizabeth Stuart	2021-2025
University of North Carolina at Greensboro PhD Coursework in Applied Economics	2020-2021
University of North Carolina at Greensboro BS in Economics, <i>summa cum laude</i> Minors: Mathematics, Philosophy	2017-2020

PUBLICATIONS

Thornburg, B., Eisenberg, M., Kennedy-Hendricks, A., Braun, RT., McGinty, E.B. (2026) Spending, Care Access, and Quality following Private Equity and Other For-Profit Acquisitions of Mental Health and Substance Use Treatment Facilities in the US
JAMA Health Forum (Forthcoming)

Shen, K., **Thornburg B.**, Kennedy-Hendricks, A., Meiselbach, M. K. (2025) Medicaid Enrollees With Opioid Use Disorder Were More Likely To Receive Medication Treatment Than Commercial Enrollees
Health Affairs

Ettman CK, Dewhurst E, Satpathy-Horton R, Hatton CR, **Thornburg B.**, Castrucci BC, Galea S. (2025) Whose assets? Individual and household income and savings and mental health in a longitudinal cohort
Social Science & Medicine

Thornburg, B., McGinty, E. B., Eddelbuettel, J., Kennedy-Hendricks, A., Braun, R.T., & Eisenberg, M. D. (2024) Acquisitions of Behavioral Health Treatment Facilities From 2010 to 2021
Health Affairs Scholar

Thornburg, B., Kennedy-Hendricks, A., Rosen, J., Eisenberg, M. (2024) Anxiety and Depression Symptoms after the *Dobbs* Abortion Decision
JAMA

Ettman, C.K., **Thornburg B.**, Abdalla S.M., Meiselbach M.K., Galea S. (2024) Financial assets and mental health over time
Scientific Reports

Dewhurst, E., Ettman, C. K., Bork, R. H., **Thornburg, B.**, Abdalla, S. M., Galea, S., and Castrucci, B. C. (2024) Symptoms of Posttraumatic Stress During the COVID-19 Pandemic in the Governmental Public Health Workforce and General Population

Journal of Public Health Management and Practice

Bray, J.W., **Thornburg, B.**, Barbosa, C., Gebrasselassie, A., Labutte, C., Wittenberg, E. (2023) Estimating Joint Health State Utility Algorithms Under Partial Information

Value in Health

Thornburg, B., Bray, JW., Wittenberg, E. (2022) Health Utility of Drinkers' Family Members: A Secondary Analysis of a US Population Data Set

Medical Decision Making Policy and Practice

Wittenberg, E., Labutte, C., **Thornburg, B.**, Gebrasselassie, A., Barbosa, C., Bray, JW., (2022) Alcohol Consumption and Health-Related Quality of Life in the US During the COVID-19 Pandemic: a US National Survey

Journal of Patient-Reported Outcomes

Wittenberg, E., Barbosa, C., Hein, R., Hudson, E., **Thornburg, B.**, Bray, JW., (2021) Health-Related Quality of Life of Alcohol Use Disorder with Co-occurring Conditions in the US Population

Drug and Alcohol Dependence

WORK IN PROGRESS

Thornburg, B., Meath T., Marsh T., McConnell J., Mehrotra A., Zhu, J.

Who is Delivering Mental Healthcare in Medicaid? Trends in Psychiatrist and Psychiatric Nurse Practitioners, 2018-2022

Health Affairs (Revise and resubmit)

Thornburg, B., Eisenberg, M., Rosen, J., Kennedy-Hendricks, A.

Utilization of Outpatient Mental Health Treatment Services Following State Restrictions on Abortion

Thornburg, B., Zirui S., Zhu, J.

Private Equity Acquisitions of Psychiatric Hospitals: Impacts on Care Access and Quality in Medicaid

Sridar, S., **Thornburg, B.**, Tormholen, K.

Trends in Private Equity Acquisitions of Substance Use Treatment Facilities

Eslami, N., **Thornburg, B.**

Bankruptcies and Closures after Private Equity Acquisition of Psychiatric Hospitals

Thornburg, B., Huntington A., McConnell J., Zhu, J.

Exit and Entry Behavior of Medicaid Managed Care Organizations: Trends in Care Disruption

Thornburg, B., Kennedy-Hendricks, A., Rosen, J., Eisenberg, M.

The Impact of State Abortion Restrictions on the Market for New Physicians

Thornburg, B., Rodriguez M.

Changes in the Incidence of Mental Illness During and After Pregnancy Related to *Dobbs v. Jackson*

HONORS AND AWARDS

Donald M. and Sharon C. Steinwachs Endowed Dissertation Award	2025
National Institute of Mental Health Training Grant (NIMH T32)	2023-2025
National Research Service Award (AHRQ T32)	2022-2023
Sir Arthur Newsholme Scholarship in Health Economics and Policy	2021-2022
MA/PhD Departmental Scholarship in Economics	2020-2021
Minerva Designation for Exemplary Doctoral Students	2020-2021
Bryan Medal for Academic Excellence	2020
Most Outstanding Undergraduate Student, Class of 2020	2020

SELECT MEDIA COVERAGE OF RESEARCH

News Coverage

The 19th (2026) [Suicide rates are higher for teen girls. Abortion bans could be making it worse.](#)

Forbes (2024) [Anxiety And Depression Symptoms Jumped After SCOTUS Overturned Roe, Study Finds](#)

Time Magazine (2024) [Abortion Restrictions Hurt Women’s Mental Health](#)

US News and World Report (2024) [Women’s Anxiety Rose in States Affected by Fall of Roe v. Wade](#)

JAMA Author Interviews Podcast (2024) [Anxiety and Depression Symptoms After the Dobbs Abortion Rights Decision](#)

Institute for Women’s Policy Research (2024) [The Economic and Workforce Implications of Restrictive Abortion Laws](#)

Appearances and Interviews

Mornings with Zerlina, Sirius XM Radio (2024) [Interviews with PhD Candidate Ben Thornburg, US Representative Lauren Underwood, and Senior White House Spokesperson Adrienne Elrod](#)

Vox (2024) [Living in an Abortion Ban State is Bad for Mental Health](#)

Hopkins Bloomberg Public Health Magazine (2024) [Ob-Gyn Training and Practice in Dobbs’ Shadow](#)

Yale Scientific Magazine (2024) [Mental Health After Dobbs](#)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instruction and Lecturing

Health Systems (<i>Lecturer, Northwest Permanente Internal Medicine Residency</i>)	2025-Present
Health Economics for Policymakers (<i>with Prof. Matthew Eisenberg</i>)	2021-2024
Intro to Health Economics (<i>with Prof. Caroline Hanson</i>)	2024
Intro to Health Economics (<i>with Prof. Brendan Rabideau</i>)	2023
Health Economics (<i>with Prof. Aditi Sen</i>)	2022
Microeconomic Theory (<i>Recitation Instructor</i>)	2020

Advising

Eslami, Noushyar (MD, 2026)

Alqahtani, Sara (MS, 2023)

Otanez, Nathanael (MS, 2023)

Pimentel, Eric Costa (MS, 2023)

Wang, Zixu (MS, 2023)

AFFILIATIONS

OHSU Health Services Research Seminar Search Committee (Member)

Center for Health Systems Effectiveness (Fellow)

Doctoral Student Council (Academic Chair)

Committee on the Status of LGBTQ+ Individuals in the Economics Profession (Trainee)

American Society of Health Economists (Member)

AcademyHealth (Member)

Hopkins Business of Health Initiative (Affiliate Trainee)

Society for Medical Decision Making (Trainee)

Southern Economic Association (Member)

SELECT PRESENTATIONS

Trends In the Delivery of Mental Health Services By Psychiatrists and Nurse Practitioners In Medicaid, 2018-2022
Podium Presentation, AcademyHealth Research Meeting (2026)

Outpatient Utilization of Mental Health Treatment Facilities following State Restrictions on Abortion
Poster, AcademyHealth Research Meeting (2026)

Spending, Care Access, and Quality following Private Equity and Other For-Profit Acquisitions of Mental Health and Substance Use Treatment Facilities in the US
Poster, AcademyHealth Research Meeting (2026)

Acquisitions of Behavioral Health Treatment Facilities From 2010 to 2021.
Podium Presentation, American Society of Health Economists Conference (2024)

Acquisitions of Behavioral Health Treatment Facilities From 2010 to 2021.
Poster, AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (2024)

Wealth Matters: Income, Savings, and Financial Stress as Determinants of Depression and Anxiety across the COVID-19 Pandemic.
Poster, AcademyHealth Research Meeting (2024)

Whose Assets? The Relation between Individual and Household Level Income and Savings with Mental Health.
Podium Presentation, AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (2024)

Private Equity Investment in Substance Use Disorder Treatment.
Presentation to the Senate Homeland Security Committee (2023)

The Overturning of *Roe*: Mental Health in the Wake of *Dobbs v. Jackson*.
Podium Presentation, AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (2023)

The Overturning of *Roe*: Mental Health in the Wake of *Dobbs v. Jackson*.
Podium Presentation, AHRQ NRSA Annual Trainees Conference (2023)

Alcohol Consumption and Health-Related Quality of Life in the US During the COVID-19 Pandemic
Podium Presentation, The Forum on NIAAA Supported COVID-19 Research (2022)

Novel Research on Alcohol Consumption and Health State Utilities.
Podium Presentation, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (2021)

Health Utility of Drinkers' Family Members: A Secondary Analysis of a US Population Data Set.
Poster, The Society for Medical Decision Making Annual North American Meeting (2021)

PEER REVIEW

Health Affairs, Journal of Clinical Epidemiology, JAMA Network Open, JAMA Health Forum, Inquiry, Sexual and Reproductive Healthcare, SAGE open nursing, Quality of Life Research

RELEVANT PROFICIENCIES AND TRAINING

Statistical Software: R, SAS, Stata, SQL

Methods: Difference-in-differences, synthetic controls, instrumental variables, regression discontinuity

Data Sources: Medicaid TAF, Medicare claims, state all payer claims, IQVIA OneKey, MarketScan, Optum

Doctoral Coursework in Economics

Consumer and Producer Theory, Game Theory, Information Economics, General Equilibrium Theory, Labor Economics, Econometric Methods, Econometric Theory, Macroeconomics, Health Economics

Doctoral Coursework in Public Health

Causal Inference in Medicine & Public Health, Biostatistics, Advanced Methods in Health Services Research